For the Serge Koussevitzky Music Foundation in the Library of Congress, dedicated to the memory of Serge and Natalie Koussevitzky

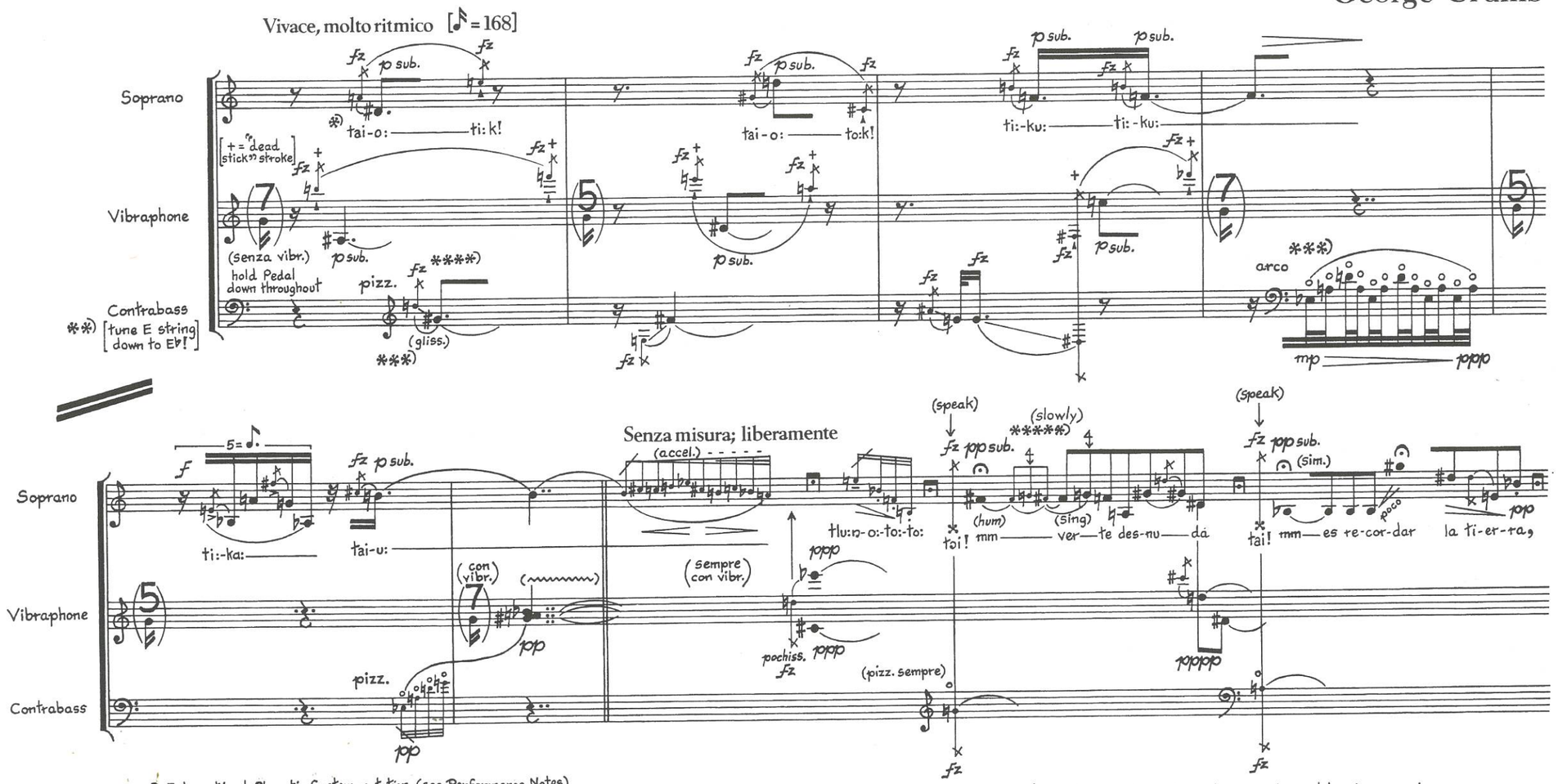
MADRIGALS, BOOK I

for Soprano, Vibraphone, and Contrabass

Based on fragments from Federico García Lorca

I. Verte desnuda es recordar la tierra
[To see you naked is to remember the earth]

George Crumb



*) International Phonetic System notation (see Performance Notes)

**) The E♭ tuning of lowest string remains unchanged throughout entire work. The notated pitches (sounding 8va lower than written) represent the actual desired pitches! The player must, therefore, compensate for all notes played on the E♭ string.

***) All Contrabass notes (including harmonics!) sound 8va lower than written.

****) When a pizzicato note is followed by a glissando to another pitch, the second note should not be replucked since it only indicates the termination point of the glissando.

*****) ↓ indicates a pitch ¼ tone lower than given pitch.

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Vivace, molto ritmico [♪=168]

Soprano: (pp) es re-cor-dar la ti-er——ra; toi-a:— toi-i:— tai-o:——(trr)—— toi-u:—— (trr)-mm (hum)

Vibraphone: (senza vibr.) (pizz. sempre); (flutter-tongue) 5=♪; senza Ped. (Ped.)

Contrabass: (pizz. sempre); throw bow! arco

Senza misura; liberamente

Soprano: (slowly) mm—— ver-te des-nu——da es re-cor-dar la tier-ra, la

Vibraphone: (very slow, languid); (lasc. vibr.)

Contrabass: (morendo al niente)

Vivace, molto ritmico [♪=168]

Soprano: tier——ra; es re-cor-dar

Vibraphone: pizz. [pizz. trem. - two fingers on string]; (gliss.)

Contrabass: arco

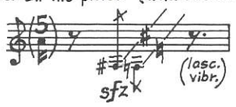
Esuberante! [♪=252]

Soprano: la tier-ra; tai-o:-ti:-ka:-ta:-i:, tai-o:-ti:k! tai-o:-ti:-ka:, tai-o:-ti:k! tai-o:-ti:k! tai-o:-ti:k!

Vibraphone: (sul D); con brio (change Pedal on each group); (senza Ped.) (quasi eco)

Contrabass: (arco); strike body of instrument with l.h. knuckles; (come sopra); (quasi eco)

(*) Strike damper bar of Vibraphone sharply so that all plates vibrate. If this effect cannot be satisfactorily achieved, a very rapid glissando over all the plates (with two mallets) may be substituted:



II. No piensan en la lluvia, y se han dormido

[They do not think of the rain, and they've fallen asleep]

Cristallino

Molto delicato [♪ = 64]

Soprano

To:ŋ — ti:ŋ — tu:ŋ —

fz pp sub. fz pp sub. fz pp sub. al niente

pp teneramente

No (senza vibr.) pien- san en la llu- via,

with mallets (modo ord.)

with fingernails

= ca. ♪

with fingernails

pppp

with mallets

Vibraphone

(con vibr.) fz pp sub. fz pp sub. fz pp sub.

Ped. * Ped. pochiss. fz pp (hold Ped. down)

with fingernails

5 = 𝅗𝅥 mp

con vibr. (subito!)

pppp

pocco f

Contrabass

(sul A) pizz. pp

fz pp sub. fz pp sub. fz pp sub. al niente

arco sul pont.

delicatiss.

pppp gliss. over harmonics (trem. sempre)

Rain-death music I.

Tempo assolutamente metronomico; con delicatezza

Soprano

(falling in pitch) pp

t-k-t-k-t (unvoiced)

fz pppp fz pppp

tai- mm tai- mm (hum)

wind sound (rising, falling)

Vibraphone

ppp (dampen E♯) (lasc. vibr.)

very light triangle beater (r.h.)

(dampen with finger)

two very soft mallets (l.h.)

[♪ = 80] pppp sempre (pochiss. in rilievo)

(sempre con vibr.)

pppp sempre (hold Ped. down)

Contrabass

[♪ = 100] (sul G) (sul E♭) (sempre sim.)

arco sempre (sul A)

ppp sempre

pizz. sempre

*) Vibraphone harmonics are produced by placing l.h. forefinger lightly against very center of plate and striking plate with a rather hard mallet. The harmonic sounds two(!) octaves higher than the fundamental.

**) The 4/8 of the Vibraphone in the time of the 5/8 of the Contrabass.

[♪=80]

Soprano: No — pien - san, — No — pien-san en la llu — via,

Vibraphone: pppp sempre

Contrabass: ppppp sempre

tristamente — grazioso — accel. — =ca. ♪ — rit.

(♪ = ♪ sempre) (sempre con vibr.)

[♪=80] (sul D) (arco) — (sul D) — (senza Ped.) — (sul Eb) — pp (½ Ped.)

Cristallino

pochiss. rit. . . .

molto più piano questa volta (quasi eco)

Soprano: en la llu — via, — To:ŋ — tu:ŋ — ti:ŋ

Vibraphone: (full Ped.) — (Ped.) — (senza Ped.)

Contrabass: ppppp

Rain-death music II.

Tempo metronomico

[♪=120] Spoken (3 levels)

Soprano: Sung (poco in rilievo) — No — ti:ŋ - ti:-ko:-ti:k, — ti:-ko:-ti:k - ti:k, — ti:ŋ - ti:-ko:-

(very soft sticks) — (delicatiss.) — (spoken:) to:ŋ — arco sul pont.

pizz. — col legno

(staccatiss.) — (spoken:) to:ŋ —

più lento

Soprano: pien-san — en — la llu- via, — y — se — han — dor-mi — do.

ti:k, — ti:ŋ - ti:-ko:-ti:k-ti:k, — to:ŋ — ti:k

Vibraphone: (ppppp sempre) — ti:ŋ — tu:ŋ —

Contrabass: col legno — arco sul pont. — (ppppp sempre) — tu:ŋ — pizz. — col legno — arco sul pont. — ti:ŋ —

*) "Rain-death music II." should be incredibly soft, i.e. almost inaudible!

**) The three spoken sounds should be quite distinct, with the "ŋ" prolonged.

III. Los muertos llevan alas de musgo
[The dead wear mossy wings]

Lento, oscuro [♪ = 40, ma flessibile]

Soprano

Vibraphone

Contrabass

quasi una chitarra bassa

(lay bow aside)

pizz. sempre

poco fz

sempre con vibr.

**glissando on one plate

hold Pedal down throughout

(hauntingly)

pizz. trem. - 2 fingers (very rapid)

straddle plate with two mallets held in right hand

(pizz. sempre)

intenso (whispered)

Los muer-tos,

gliss. on one plate (come sopra)

[Vibraphonist walks to Contrabass]

(arpegg. sempre sim.)

accel. 10= rit.

pizz. trem. (come sopra)

(whispered) intenso

Los muer - tos

(pizz. sempre)

(pizz. trem.)

= ca. ♩

trem. (pizz.)

*) ↓ indicates a pitch ¼ tone lower than written pitch.

**) The ½ tone glissando is obtained by holding a hard mallet (with left hand) against end of plate as plate is struck in conventional manner (with right hand) with another (rather hard) mallet. The left hand mallet should lightly touch a point about ½ inch from end of plate and immediately after plate is struck, the player should gradually increase pressure and at the same time move the mallet head to the very end of the plate. In this way, the pitch is "bent" down ½ step.

Senza misura, liberamente; sempre lentamente, esitante

Soprano

(whispered)

mp (poco più intenso)

Los muer-tos lle-van a- las de mus — go,

Vibraphonist plays on strings of Cb. with Vbph. mallets!

Vibraphone

mp (whispered)

Los muer-tos

(on 2 lowest strings)

pp poco

Contrabass

(silently finger these notes)

(on 3 top strings)

poco fz

al niente

fuggevole

mp

(oscillando)

ppp

(a) a-las de mus — go, — de (e) mus — go, — mus

[Vibraphonist returns to normal position]

modo ord.

ppppp

(hold Pedal down throughout)

pp

ppppp

(poco)

ppp

mus

pp sub.

pochiss. fz

Soprano

go,

mus — go, — mm — (hum) mm —

with wire brushes!

r.h.

l.h.

fz

mp

(trem.)

(l.v.)

(r.h.)

(wire brushes)

pp

rit.

a las de mus — go — (o)

(gliss. sempre)

mp

(gliss.)

pp

Vibraphone

pp(>) gliss. on one plate (come sopra)

(l.v.)

(sul D) pizz.

ppp

ppppp

(pizz.)

(slow gliss.)

gliss.

(l.h.)

pp

(take up bow)

arco sul pont. con sordino!

ppppp quasi niente

Contrabass

Soprano

(hum)

mm

very soft sticks

(unvoiced)

ppp

ppppp

pppppp

oi

**) T

Vibraphone

pppp sempre

poco fz

p

pp

ppppp

pppp

pppppp

Contrabass

modo ord. (sempre, con sord.)

pizz.

pppp legato possibile (change bow when necessary)

(3rd partial harmonics on the four strings)

ppppp

*) gently wafting

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*) The alignment of parts as given in the score should be reproduced as accurately as possible.

**) Play 4 notes marked "T" with a very light triangle beater.

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